

# WooCommerce Performance Checklist

18 fixes that make a slow store fast. Most take under an hour — start at the top, measure after each block.

## 1 HOSTING & CORE

- ☐ **PHP 8.2+** — each major PHP version is a free ~10–20% speed-up.
- ☐ **Object cache on** (Redis / Memcached) — biggest single win for logged-in and cart pages.
- ☐ **WordPress & Woo updated** — recent releases carry real performance patches.

## 2 CACHING

- ☐ **Full-page cache** for shop & product pages — **exclude** cart, checkout, my-account.
- ☐ **CDN** for images, CSS and JS (Cloudflare free tier is enough to start).
- ☐ **Browser caching headers** — a returning visitor should re-download almost nothing.

## 3 IMAGES

- ☐ **WebP/AVIF** for product photos — typically 30–70% smaller than JPEG.
- ☐ **Lazy-load** everything below the fold; **never** lazy-load the hero/LCP image.
- ☐ **Right-sized files** — no 4000px originals squeezed into a 300px grid cell.

## 4 DATABASE

- ☐ **Autoloaded options < 1 MB** — bloat here slows literally every request.
- ☐ **Purge expired transients** and old Woo sessions on a schedule.
- ☐ **Trim revisions & orphaned postmeta** — smaller tables, faster product queries.

## 5 PLUGINS & THEME

- ☐ **Profile with Query Monitor** — find the 2–3 plugins eating most of the load time.
- ☐ **Deactivate AND delete** what you don't use; replace heavy multi-purpose plugins.
- ☐ **Page-builder audit** — builder bloat on product pages is a top LCP killer.

## 6 FRONTEND

- ☐ **Defer non-critical JS**; load analytics/chat widgets after interaction.
- ☐ **Host fonts locally**, max 2 families — skip the Google Fonts round-trip.
- ☐ **Disable cart-fragments AJAX** on non-shop pages — a classic hidden Woo tax.

TARGETS  
AFTER  
CLEANUP

**LCP < 2.5s**  
LARGEST PAINT

**INP < 200ms**  
INTERACTION

**CLS < 0.1**  
LAYOUT SHIFT

**< 600ms**  
SERVER TTFB

Measure on PageSpeed Insights, **mobile** tab — that's what Google ranks you on.